[Metric]
A-A-2910
September 29, 1995
Superseding
SS-P-186E
October 24, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
3.05MM LEADS, FOR CHINA MARKING, MECHANICAL PENCILS
(COLORED, WAX)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description by all federal agencies and will replace Federal Specification **SS-P-186E Type I (c).**

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers wax leads for mechanical china marking pencils.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 Composition. Leads shall be of a clay or wax composition and shall produce clear visible markings good color, continuous and free from chips and crumbs. Writing on all surfaces shall be clearly legible.

2.2 Strength & Resilience. Leads shall be continuously smooth marking and shall be of such strength and resilience so as to reduce breakage when used properly.

2.3 Length & Diameter of Lead. Lead length shall be 69.8mm ± 2mm and the diameter shall be 3mm ± 0.1mm.

2.4 Workmanship. Leads shall conform to normal commercial practice, as applicable, and shall be suitable for the purpose intended. Leads shall be free from any defects which affect their appearance and serviceability.

2.5 Leads shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Blue, Green, Red, Yellow, Orange, Purple, and White or as specified in paragraph 6.2.

2.6 The pencils shall be capable of writing on the following glossy-surface materials: glass, aluminum, including aluminum foil; cellophane and cellulose acetate adhesive tape, and glazed white porcelain.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

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3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing.

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offerror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one lead. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual & dimensional examination shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. For performance testing the level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

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4.3 Performance Testing:

4.3.1 Breaking Strength. Wax lead and mechanical holder shall be placed in a ridge holding block set to maintain a constant angle of 45° to 50° between the pencil and the platform. The pencil shall extend beyond the underside of the block 31.75mm (1 1/4 inches) to 38.10mm (1 1/2 inches), measured along the pencil to the end of the prepared end. The scale platform shall be smooth and shall offer no resistance to the point moving across its surface. Pressure shall be applied by pushing the rod, which holds the block, down gradually and uniformly in order to avoid variations and shock. Readings shall be taken at the instant of breaking, provided the breaking point is definite. A slow, mushy deformation or crumbling shall be considered as a break with the reading to be taken as nearly as possible to the point where this type of failure begins. The breaking strength shall be based on the average of all tests made. Not less than three leads of a color shall be used and each lead shall be subjected to not less than four tests. All leads and mechanical pencils being used as holding devices shall be tested at a temperature of not less than 23° + 1.1°C (73.5° + 2°F) relative humidity 50 + 4%, for a minimum of 12 hours preceding the test.

5. Packaging: Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Notes:

6.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Application for copies of ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 can be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

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6.2 Ordering Information: Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the lead color. If (other) color is required, the color shall be specified and degree of hardness.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and facilities if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment.
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar coding is not required.
G. Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.

6.3 National Stock Number Listing:

Leads, China, Marking
Colored - Wax

7510-00-223-6690
7510-00-223-6691
7510-00-223-6692
7510-00-223-6693
7510-00-223-6694
7510-00-223-6695
7510-00-254-4530
7510-00-256-4092

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has waived coordination on revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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